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AFTER FLOODS, VT. TOWN AIMS TO RISE ABOVE IT ALL

With catastrophes becoming more common, a plan to move to higher ground



PAUL HEINTZ FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

The Heartbreak Hotel apartment building is barely hanging on after floods in Plainfield, Vt., in 2023 and 2024.

By Paul Heintz

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

PLAINFIELD, Vt. — One year after flood waters swept through this village, the shattered remnants of a building known as the Heartbreak Hotel still loom over the brook that destroyed it.

The 140-year-old structure acquired its nickname, according to local legend, when down-on-their-luck mill workers and jilted lovers posted up in its affordable apartments. Twelve people were living there last summer when a torrent of water dislodged much of the building and dispatched it down the Great Brook. The tenants all escaped, though five cats did not.

The damage left the kitchens of two remaining apartments, with dishwashers, sinks, and cupboards still intact, exposed and easily visible to anyone crossing a rebuilt bridge just upstream of the building.

“It’s like looking at a dollhouse, you know?” said neighbor Lauren Geiger as she gestured toward the wreckage. “It’s so traumatizing for the people who’ve lived there to have to walk by this place all the time. It’s just heartbreaking, really.”

Much of Vermont continues to reckon with the damage from the seven federally declared major disasters that struck the state over the past two years. The worst were a pair of floods that inundated Vermont precisely one year apart, on

VERMONT, Page A10

PARTS OF MASS. SWAMPED



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

Powerful thunderstorms inundated areas south of Boston with several inches of rain Thursday morning, forcing the closure of Interstate 93 for a time. In Cohasset (above), a car was towed from Route 3A South. **B1.**

New dean of Harvard faces a challenge

Deming in spotlight with undergraduate tensions still high

By Aidan Ryan

GLOBE STAFF

As a political economist at Harvard University, David Deming spent his days studying how elite universities enhance social mobility of their graduates, arguing that top colleges should bestow their benefits on a more diverse mix of students.

By night, Deming served as a faculty dean for Harvard College’s Kirkland House, where he helped shape the culture of a student residence that is a social hub for hundreds of undergraduates.

Now, Deming has been appointed dean of Harvard College, a role that will test his strengths as both an academic and community builder. The position — which oversees virtually all undergraduate life — is typically a quiet role outside of campus, but one with enormous importance within Harvard’s gates.

While Deming won’t be leading

the university’s response to the Trump administration’s pressure campaign, his position will be more important than ever as he steers the college through uncertainty with the world watching.

“David is uniquely well suited to lead the college at this consequential moment in Harvard’s history,” Hopi Hoekstra, Harvard’s dean of the Faculty of Arts and Sciences, said when Deming was appointed in May.

Deming, who took office on July 1, succeeds Rakesh Khurana, who said last fall that he would step

HARVARD, Page A6

Israel has reportedly concluded that some of Iran’s underground stockpile of enriched uranium survived American and Israeli attacks last month. **A3.**



American Amanda Anisimova celebrated after shocking No. 1-ranked Aryna Sabalenka at Wimbledon and advancing to the final. **C1.**

The Social Security Administration is adding staff to its customer service phone operations to address a massive influx of calls. **A2.**

In the thick of it

Friday: Some sun, humid. High 74-79. Low 64-69.

Saturday: More of the same. High 74-79. Low 63-68.

Sunrise: 5:18 Sunset: 8:21

Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C9.

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00

By Angela Mathew

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Thomas Gee, a former gymnast, used to do handstands, perform wheelies on his skateboard, and run around with his three young children. But in 2001, a marble-sized bump on his left leg swelled to the size of a football. Gee was diagnosed with soft tissue sarcoma, a form of cancer that required the amputation of his leg above the knee.

After his surgery, Gee remained active but switched to walking instead of running with his kids. His prosthetic leg had a suction fit and a hydraulic knee, but it was far from satisfactory.

“I would fall at least once a month,” Gee said. “When you step on an uneven surface and the toe triggers the knee, all of a sudden there’s no resistance anymore, and you just go right straight down.”

Now, because of a new bionic knee developed by MIT researchers, Gee, 63, is able to kick a ball again and walk upstairs without having to stop on each step.

“I kept saying, ‘I got my leg back,’” Gee said of the prosthesis. “It wasn’t just a piece of hardware attached to my leg.”

Gee is one of 15 volunteers to participate in a clinical trial for the prosthesis, the results of which were published Thursday in the journal Science.

From January 2023 to early 2024, Gee traveled from his home in Litchfield, N.H., to MIT in Cambridge to spend four to eight hours testing out the prosthesis. The bionic knee is the first of its kind to integrate with a patient’s bones and nervous system, allowing users to control the prosthesis with their mind.

“In conventional prostheses, there’s an ener-

KNEE, Page A7



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Thomas Gee is one of 15 volunteers to participate in a clinical trial for the bionic prosthesis.

Birthright citizenship order is blocked

Judge in N.H. certifies suit as class action to get around Supreme Court ruling

By Zach Montague and Pat Grossmith

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — A federal judge on Thursday blocked the Trump administration from enforcing a contentious executive order ending birthright citizenship after certifying a lawsuit as a class action, effectively the only way he could impose such a far-reaching limit after a Supreme Court ruling last month.

Ruling from the bench, Judge Joseph N. Laplante of US District Court for the District of New Hampshire said his decision applied nationwide to babies who would have been subject to the executive order, which included the children of parents lacking permanent legal status and those born to academics in the United States on student visas, on or after Feb. 20.

The Trump administration has fought to challenge the longstanding law, laid out in the Constitution, that people born in the United States are automatically citizens, regardless of their parents’ immigration status. Laplante’s order reignites a legal standoff that has been underway since the beginning of President Trump’s second term.

The judge, an appointee of President George W. Bush, issued a written order formalizing the ruling Thursday morning. He also paused his order for seven days, allowing time for an appeal.

The lawsuit was brought by the American Civil

BIRTHRIGHT, Page A5

ICE official says blacklist used to identify Öztürk

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio and Shelley Murphy

GLOBE STAFF

An immigration official disclosed Thursday that the agency relied heavily on a pro-Israel website to identify international students who protested the war in Gaza, including Tufts PhD candidate Rümeysa Öztürk, as part of the Trump administration’s crackdown on the pro-Palestinian movement on college campuses.

Under questioning in federal court in Boston, the official from Immigration and Customs Enforcement did not point to any other grounds for Öztürk’s detention beyond her inclusion in the blacklist from the website, known as Canary Mission, or her coauthoring of an op-ed in the student newspaper calling on Tufts to divest from companies with ties to Israel.

Those details came to light during the trial of a lawsuit brought by higher education organizations, including the American Association of University Professors, over the Trump administration’s policies of arresting and detaining noncitizen students and others engaged in pro-Palestinian activism.

On Thursday, Alexandra Conlon, an attorney for the plaintiffs, displayed in court a report on Öztürk, who was arrested by masked immigration agents on a Somerville street in March. The document, titled “Report of Analysis,” was a subject profile of Öztürk, and partially unveiled for the first time. Under a section titled “social me-

IMMIGRATION, Page A6

With integrated bionic knee, ‘I got my leg back’